



AFP

Italy defends Billie Jean King Cup

Italy successfully defended its Billie Jean King Cup with a 2-0 victory over record 18-time champion, the United States, taking its own tally in the premier women's team competition to six titles.

Elisabetta Cocciaretto and Jasmine Paolini both won their singles matches to help their country triumph in Shenzhen and prolonged the American

wait for another title after its previous success in 2017.

World number eight Paolini's 6-4, 6-2 victory was her maiden win in her sixth clash with Jessica Pegula and helped Italy become the first team to capture back-to-back titles since the Czech Republic lifted three straight trophies from 2014-16.